PREMIER LEAGUE 2026/27 · MATCHWEEK 2

# Chelsea v Brighton & Hove Albion

Stamford Bridge, London · August 30, 2026 (Sunday) · Kickoff 8:00 AM Central / 14:00 UK

**OFFICIAL STARTING XI**

| NO. | PLAYER / POSITION | FROM | AT CHELSEA | PREVIOUSLY | PLAYING STYLE | KEY STATS |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **1** GK | **Emiliano Martínez** GOALKEEPER | Argentina | August 2026, £7.5m from Aston Villa — signed the morning… | Aston Villa; Arsenal; loans at Oxford United, Sheffield… | World Cup winner and a renowned penalty specialist — commanding, vocal, and a serial big-moment goalkeeper. | 2025–26, ASTON VILLA 95 saves, 32 apps |
| **33** RCB | **Wesley Fofana** CENTRE-BACK | France | Since Aug 2022, about £70m from Leicester City | Leicester City; Saint-Étienne | Quick, aggressive and front-footed, strong in single combat and comfortable defending a high line. | 2025–26, CHELSEA 25 apps, 1,727 minutes |
| **5** CB | **Maxence Lacroix** CENTRE-BACK | France | July 2026, about £52m ($69m) from Crystal Palace | Crystal Palace; Wolfsburg; Sochaux | Reportedly the fastest centre-back in the Premier League by top speed. | 2025–26, CRYSTAL PALACE 35 apps (all starts), 11 clean sheets |
| **6** LCB | **Levi Colwill** LEFT CENTRE-BACK | England | Academy from 2012; first team since 2023 — 4th senior… | Chelsea academy; Huddersfield Town & Brighton (loans) | Left-footed, unflustered, progresses the ball through the left channel rather than sideways around it. | 2025–26, CHELSEA — ACL RECOVERY 4 apps |
| **7** RWB | **Pedro Neto** WINGER | Portugal | Since July 2024, about £54m from Wolves | Wolverhampton Wanderers; Lazio; Braga academy | Direct, one-v-one dribbler who attacks the byline and cuts back. | 2025–26, CHELSEA 5 goals, 6 assists |
| **27** CM | **Malo Gusto** RIGHT WING-BACK | France | Since Jan 2023 from Lyon | Olympique Lyonnais | Energetic, tenacious right-sided defender who overlaps hard and defends the touchline aggressively. | 2025–26, CHELSEA 34 apps, 3 assists |
| **45** CM | **Romeo Lavia** CENTRAL MIDFIELD | Belgium | Since Aug 2023 from Southampton | Southampton; Manchester City academy; Anderlecht academy | Press-resistant holding midfielder who turns out of pressure and keeps the ball moving in tight areas. | 2025–26, CHELSEA — INJURY-HIT 8 apps |
| **21** LWB | **Jorrel Hato** LEFT WING-BACK / CENTRE-BACK | Netherlands | Since Aug 2025, £35.5m plus add-ons — 2nd season | Ajax; Sparta Rotterdam academy | Left-footed, positionally mature well beyond his age, and more defender than flying full-back. | 2025–26, CHELSEA 22 apps (12 starts) |
| **10** AM | **Cole Palmer** ATTACKING MIDFIELD | England | Since Sept 2023, £40m — 4th season | Manchester City (academy and first team) | Left-footed, drifts inside from the right, arrives late into the box, ice-cold from the penalty spot. | 2025–26, CHELSEA 10 goals, 1 assist |
| **17** AM | **Morgan Rogers** ATTACKING MIDFIELD | England | July 2026, £117m ($157m) from Aston Villa — club record… | Aston Villa; Middlesbrough; Manchester City academy; loans… | Powerful, low-slung ball carrier who takes possession on the half-turn and drives straight at defenders, and presses like a midfielder. | 2025–26, ASTON VILLA 10 goals, 6 assists |
| **9** ST | **João Pedro** CENTRE-FORWARD | Brazil | Since July 2025, £55m plus £5m | Brighton; Watford; Fluminense | Mobile, link-heavy forward rather than a target man: drops between the lines, spins in behind, presses from the front. | 2025–26, CHELSEA 15 goals, 5 assists |

Official starting XI, confirmed 6:20 AM CT. Last updated August 30, 2026, 9:30 AM CT. chelsea-fc-2026-27.netlify.app